

Round 2 Interviews - De-identified

Behaviour & motivation interviews, concept revealed only at the end

All names removed per team's ethics decision. Participants labelled by number only.

Participant 1

Shares visual content on Instagram, written thoughts on Twitter/Reddit. Perfectionism around sharing eased over years - platform "become more for me than for anyone else." Doesn't hold back sharing much - uses close-friends sharing features. Uses Instagram as primary cultural discovery tool, values global reach. Deliberately seeks diverse perspectives rather than one personalised feed.

Names the algorithm trap directly: *"The algo circle... traps you in... you won't even know, you've blinked, an hour's gone, and you've forgotten why you came there in the first place."*

On someone copying his work: depends entirely on the copier's intention - good faith is fine, bad faith should be confronted. On friend coordination: adapts to occasion formality but otherwise brings his own vibe.

Participant 2

After creating something, first instinct is to eat, then put on music and sing along - opens Spotify, not a camera app. Keeps mood-based playlists (sad/happy/spiritual). Holds back sharing due to perfectionism - reviews content 15-20 times. Loves cooking (full creative expression) and singing along to music.

Seeks cultural motivation through a mix of video, music, and speaking thoughts aloud. Used spiritual music specifically to de-stress after a hard week. Clear distinction: inspiration = intellectual value; killing time = none.

On others' posts: wants to build on/improve what inspires him, moves past "brain rot." Holds back responding sometimes out of respect for others' perspective - doesn't want to "poke my nose" into their way of thinking. Adapts to group preference before going out but will still suggest his own idea.

On someone copying his work: feels flattered, doesn't need credit - "if they're getting inspired, that means I'm doing something good."

Participant 3

Shares to Instagram story/group chat first; main account only if genuinely proud. Checks how something looks as a story, or asks a friend's opinion before posting. Holds back if too personal, unfinished, or fears comparison to others' content.

Moves across Instagram/TikTok/Spotify by category. Real example: outfit search for dinner - cross-platform browsing (Instagram to TikTok), saved ideas, showed friends before deciding. Clear inspiration-vs-killing-time distinction: active saving/searching vs. scrolling with nothing remembered.

Mostly lurks on others' posts; if inspired, saves privately rather than publicly building on it. Held back replying to avoid seeming competitive or "making it about them." Reaction to someone's similar take: flattering if it's clearly their own version; annoyed only at an exact, unacknowledged copy.

Confirms real friend coordination for birthdays/dinners - group chat asks what everyone's wearing, songs shared while getting ready, loose vibe without being a strict uniform. Willing to adjust "a little" to not feel out of place.

On the concept: *"It makes more sense now. I like that it's one curated thing rather than an endless feed. I could see myself checking it daily if it was quick and the Threads were actually different each day."* Category preference: music first (daily habit), then fashion.

Participant 4

Doesn't share everything - visual/food/design ideas often sent directly to a few people rather than posted. Reviews on camera roll before deciding whether to send anywhere via WhatsApp/Instagram. Holds back often - dislikes "posting for the sake of posting."

Explicitly does not browse by open category - follows a trail from something already trusted (an artist, a friend's recommendation, a restaurant page, a film review, an event page): *"I don't normally open an app and think 'show me culture.'"* Real trail example: a friend's song, then the artist, then similar artists, then live performances - described this as feeling more intentional than accepting a playlist.

Clear inspiration-vs-time distinction: leaves inspiration sessions with something concrete (a song, a place, an idea); killing time is automatic and unremembered. Prefers to appreciate others' work quietly rather than publicly critique unless invited. Holds back commenting due to tone concerns - online comments can read harsher than intended, doesn't want unsolicited discussion with near-strangers.

On someone's similar take: mostly flattering, curious about the differences, could make an idea "feel more social rather than everyone creating in isolation." Confirms coordination for bigger events only (concert, wedding, big night out) - not everyday. Would adjust only if it affected the setting; for music, would add to the vibe rather than copy exactly.

On the concept: *"The daily Thread is the part I'd use. The fact that it locks at midnight gives it a reason to check without needing to scroll forever. I'd probably ignore it if the curation started feeling random or promotional."* Category preference: food or music - food connects to "places, traditions and things I can actually try."

Participant 5

Saves creative work first, decides where it belongs later - comfortable leaving things unfinished in private files. Compares mood/presentation across Pinterest/Instagram before deciding how to show something. Overthinks originality and whether posting makes something “feel less personal” - much more comfortable sharing with a small group.

Uses distinct, deliberate tools per category (Pinterest for visual references, Spotify for music, Letterboxd for film, Instagram for artists/fashion); friends are a major discovery source for things she wouldn't search herself. Real example: poster references - one saved Pinterest image, then related images, then designer lookup, then a folder of colours/type/images.

Clear inspiration-vs-time distinction: inspiration builds connections between things; killing time blurs everything together - “consuming more than thinking.” Wants to understand others' creative approach and sometimes make her own response, but won't critique uninvited. Avoids public responses because it can feel like “putting yourself next to their work for comparison” - sometimes creates privately and never shows the original poster.

On someone's similar take: welcomes genuinely different interpretations; only annoyed by exact-execution copying. Confirms real friend coordination - outfit photos before events, shared playlists for road trips/parties/study sessions, theme emerging naturally from the group. Would treat a shared theme as “a creative prompt... while still feeling like me.”

On the concept: *“This actually makes the concept more interesting to me. A single curated Thread feels more intentional than another feed, and the archive would be useful... I'd check it regularly if the curator choices felt credible.”* Category preference: art/design first, then music - *“I'd be most interested in seeing combinations I wouldn't have put together myself.”*

Participant 6

Keeps creative work (quick edits, layouts) private or shared only with close friends/family who “get the context” - rarely goes to a public feed. Reviews his own work one last time (in the gallery/editing app) before deciding to send it anywhere. Holds back due to fear of judgment and perfectionism - half-baked ideas stay private rather than risk overthinking a caption.

Music is always his starting point for cultural motivation - mood-dependent genre mixing (hip-hop, EDM, old Hindi classics, local trending artists) via YouTube Music. Real example: searching for living-room layout references and sketching options to make a cramped room feel open - a design/architecture-adjacent discovery behaviour.

Clear inspiration-vs-time distinction: mindless scrolling through shorts vs. actively screenshotting/comparing options while solving a real problem. Mostly moves past others' posts without commenting; rarely feels the urge to critique. Held back responding mainly due to lack of familiarity with the poster - commenting on an acquaintance's post feels “awkward,” unlike someone he's actually in touch with.

On someone's similar take: **a mix of emotions** - flattery, curiosity, and "a tiny bit of competitive drive." Coordinates with friends only for theme parties (group chat asking what everyone's wearing); otherwise not a planned uniform. Would roughly match a laid-back group's energy without overthinking exact details.

On the concept: *"This sounds really interesting... it puts all the endless [scroll] and algorithm noise [aside]... especially since it locks at midnight."* But flags adoption risk specifically: *"I'd have to see if it is generally cool or just like one more app notification I'm ignoring by Tuesday afternoon."* Category preference: music first (specifically beats over lyrics, mood-dependent), then design/film.

Participant 7

Mostly keeps creative work in personal notes, archives, or gallery - barely posts anything publicly.

First instinct after creating something: a camera or recording tool used to capture the moment as a memory - including voice notes - rather than a sharing app.

Holds back from sharing due to fear of judgment or feeling something isn't good enough. Seeks cultural motivation broadly - YouTube (music and art videos), conversations with people, and world news - describes it as "a vast space." Real example: looking for outfit inspiration based on an admired artist's style ahead of a uni day; didn't find anything concrete but took loose inspiration from the artist's videos.

Distinguishes inspiration from killing time partly by format - prefers visuals over reading, occasionally finds creativity "by mistake" while otherwise killing time on Instagram, versus more deliberate use of YouTube/other visual platforms for real information.

On others' posts: supportive by default, willing to critique when warranted, but **specifically wants the option to critique anonymously**. Held back from responding in the past out of fear of "being judged for judging."

On someone taking a similar creative direction to his own: fully open - takes both praise and criticism constructively, sees no issue with it, suggests it could have taken him to "a very different place."

On friend coordination: wants to match the group's vibe without directly copying them; wouldn't significantly change his choice even if friends had already picked a theme.

Closing reflection, offered unprompted: *"I believe everything relates to everything - it's all about the moment you're given, and you just have to live it, else capture it, archive it."*